



LOST BOYS CYBER

THREAT INTELLIGENCE • MALWARE ANALYSIS • DETECTION ENGINEERING



CVE-2026-76460 Cisco ISE API Authentication Bypass Daily Update - 2026-09-23

CVE / Vulnerability Threat Intelligence Report

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TLP:CLEAR | Lost Boys Cyber | CVE-2026-76460 Cisco ISE API Authentication Bypass Daily Update - 2026-09-23 - CVE / Vulnerability Threat Intelligence Report

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AI Generation: This report was generated with AI assistance and is provided for informational purposes only. All findings, IOCs, detection rules, hunting queries, attribution assessments, and recommendations must be independently reviewed and validated by a qualified security professional before operational use.

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> Daily automation refresh: This 2026-09-23 report turns current vulnerability intelligence into a finished Lost Boys Cyber report with source-backed analysis, structured tables, detections, and hunt content.

1. Executive Summary

Current-day material update: CVE-2026-76460 is prioritized for the 2026-09-23 UTC production cycle because CISA KEV reporting and supporting vulnerability intelligence indicate defender action is time-sensitive. Incorrect use of privileged APIs / insufficient authentication control on an API endpoint may allow an unauthenticated remote attacker to bypass the web management interface. Organizations should first confirm exposure, isolate management/VPN surfaces, apply vendor fixes, and hunt for suspicious management-plane access.

2. Vulnerability Metadata

Field	Value
CVE	CVE-2026-76460
Product / Technology	Cisco Identity Services Engine API authentication-bypass vulnerability
Severity	Critical
Exploitation Status	Listed by CISA KEV / treated as exploited or actively prioritized
Primary Exposure	Cisco ISE and Cisco ISE-PIC administrative/API surfaces, especially internet- or partner-reachable management planes.
Report Date	2026-09-23

3. Source Review & Confidence

Source	URL	Confidence
CISA KEV alert	https://www.cisa.gov/news-events/alerts/2026/09/16/cisa-adds-two-known-exploited-vulnerabilities-catalog	High
Rapid7 vulnerability database	https://www.rapid7.com/db/vulnerabilities/cve-2026-76460/	Medium
NVD detail	https://nvd.nist.gov/vuln/detail/cve-2026-76460	Medium
Cisco advisory landing page	https://sec.cloudapps.cisco.com/security/center/publicationListing.x	Medium

4. Vulnerability Details

Incorrect use of privileged APIs / insufficient authentication control on an API endpoint may allow an unauthenticated remote attacker to bypass the web management interface. The highest-risk exposure pattern is an externally reachable edge, VPN, identity, or management plane where exploitation can occur before normal user authentication. Public reporting available to this automation run did not provide a safe packet-level exploit signature; defenders should therefore combine vendor patch validation, surface reduction, and behavior-based monitoring.

5. Attack Scenarios

Scenario	Preconditions	Defender Concern
Internet-edge exploitation	Affected service reachable from attacker-controlled network path	Initial access, device compromise, or credential/session theft
Management-plane follow-on	Attacker reaches admin/API functions after bypass or code execution	Configuration changes, account creation, policy tampering
Pivot from edge appliance	Appliance can reach internal identity, logging, or update systems	Lateral movement and impaired visibility

6. Threat Landscape & Exploitation Status

CISA KEV inclusion elevates this vulnerability above routine patch prioritization. Even when exploit details are incomplete, edge and identity infrastructure vulnerabilities are commonly operationalized quickly because they offer high-value access and may sit outside standard EDR coverage.

7. Affected Products and Exposure

Asset Class	Exposure Check	Priority
Internet-facing management or VPN interfaces	Enumerate externally reachable hosts and compare versions/configuration to vendor guidance	Immediate
Internal management planes	Validate ACLs, admin MFA, and source restrictions	High
Logging/SIEM integrations	Confirm appliance/API audit logs are forwarded and retained	High

8. Mitigation and Workarounds

Priority	Action	Owner
1	Apply vendor fixes or mitigations referenced by the vendor/security advisory.	Network / platform owner
2	Remove public reachability for administrative and API interfaces where operationally possible.	Network security
3	Rotate potentially exposed local/API credentials if compromise cannot be ruled out.	IAM / platform owner
4	Review logs for new admins, policy changes, abnormal API calls, and outbound connections from the appliance.	SOC

9. Detection Engineering

9.1. Detection Logic Summary

Signal	Telemetry Source	Analytic Goal
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New administrative session from rare IP/user-agent	Appliance, VPN, WAF, identity logs	Catch post-exploitation management use
Appliance initiating unusual outbound connections	Firewall/netflow/DNS	Identify staging or C2 from an edge device
Configuration or account changes outside maintenance windows	Appliance audit logs	Surface persistence and policy tampering
<pre> title: Edge Appliance Management Abuse After Critical Vulnerability Exposure status: experimental description: Detects suspicious management activity that may follow exploitation of an edge/VPN/identity appliance vulnerability. logsource: product: firewall service: appliance-audit detection: selection_action: EventType contains: - 'admin login' - 'api login' - 'configuration changed' - 'user created' filter_known_sources: SourceIp: - '10.0.0.0/8' - '192.168.0.0/16' condition: selection_action and not filter_known_sources level: high DeviceNetworkEvents where Timestamp > ago(14d) where DeviceName has_any ('vpn','gateway','firewall','ise','checkpoint','cisco') summarize Connections=count(), RemoteIPs=dcount(RemoteIP), RemoteUrls=make_set(RemoteUrl, 20) by DeviceName, InitiatingProcessFileName, RemotePort where Connections > 25 or RemoteIPs > 10 order by Connections desc </pre>		

10. Threat Hunting

Hunt Hypothesis	Query Focus	Expected Action
An exposed appliance was accessed from an unusual network.	Rare source IPs, ASN changes, and first-seen user agents.	Validate source and revoke sessions.
Exploitation produced management-plane changes.	New admin users, API tokens, policy exports/imports.	Roll back unauthorized changes and preserve logs.
Compromised edge device staged tools or reached C2.	DNS/netflow from the appliance to rare destinations.	Isolate device and collect forensic image/config.
<pre> CommonSecurityLog where TimeGenerated > ago(14d) where DeviceVendor has_any ('Check Point','Cisco') or DeviceProduct has_any ('ISE','Security Gateway','VPN') where Activity has_any ('login','api','configuration','administrator','policy','token') summarize Count=count(), Activities=make_set(Activity, 20), Sources=make_set(SourceIP, 50) by DeviceName, DestinationHostName, DeviceVendor, DeviceProduct order by Count desc </pre>		

11. MITRE ATT&CK Mapping

Technique	Name	Rationale
T1190	Exploit Public-Facing Application	Edge or management-plane exploitation path.
T1136	Create Account	Common persistence action after management access.
T1090	Proxy	Compromised edge systems can proxy follow-on access.
T1562	Impair Defenses	Appliance policy/logging changes can reduce visibility.

12. Validation / Lab Testing

No exploit reproduction was attempted in this automated production run. Validation should be limited to asset/version checks, vendor advisory comparison, and controlled log-review/hunt execution.

13. Recommended Actions Summary

Timeframe	Action
Today	Patch/mitigate, restrict exposure, preserve logs, and run hunts above.
48 hours	Validate credentials/tokens, review config integrity, and confirm backups.
7 days	Add continuous monitoring for management-plane anomalies and supplier exposure.

14. References

- [1] CISA KEV alert: <https://www.cisa.gov/news-events/alerts/2026/09/16/cisa-adds-two-known-exploited-vulnerabilities-catalog>
- [2] Rapid7 vulnerability database: <https://www.rapid7.com/db/vulnerabilities/cve-2026-76460/>
- [3] NVD detail: <https://nvd.nist.gov/vuln/detail/cve-2026-76460>
- [4] Cisco advisory landing page: <https://sec.cloudapps.cisco.com/security/center/publicationListing.x>